How much to charge, and how to tell them

You are a student in Germany. You already did this path yourself, so you can guide another student. You are not a lawyer, not an embassy officer, and not a big agency. Say that in the first conversation. People trust a clear student more than someone who pretends to guarantee a visa.

Say this in your own words

"I am a student in Germany. I know the steps because I went through them: choosing a university, the application, the money proof, and the visa papers. I will show you what to do and check your documents. I cannot promise that a university will accept you, and I cannot promise that the embassy will give a visa. Those decisions are not mine. My fee is low because I am a student helping a student, and I only take a few people at a time."

1. What you are selling

You are selling your time, your experience, and a clear order of steps. You are not selling a seat in a university and you are not selling a visa.

You can honestly help with

- Checking whether their marks, language, and budget fit the kind of programme they want.
- Making a shortlist of public universities and naming the real deadline for each one.
- Explaining uni-assist and direct university applications in simple words.
- Reading their CV and motivation letter and telling them what is weak or unclear.
- Building a document checklist from the university page and from the German embassy page for their country.
- Explaining the blocked account, health insurance, and the first weeks after arrival: city registration, a normal bank account, and the semester contribution.

Say these limits every time, before they pay

- You do not guarantee admission.
- You do not guarantee a visa.
- You do not have a special contact inside the embassy or the university.
- You do not invent work experience, bank money, or language scores.
- You do not tell them to hide a previous refusal. A refusal must be declared if the form asks.
- Translations, exam fees, the blocked-account deposit, the visa fee, and the semester contribution are their costs, not part of your fee.

2. How much you should charge

Charge enough that your time is respected, and less than a big agency. A full agency package is often several hundred to a couple of thousand euro. Your full guide at **€249** is a low fee, and it is still fair if you spend about 8 to 12 hours on that person.

Package	Charge	What they get
First talk	**Free · 15 minutes**	You listen, you say if you can help, you do not start the real work.

Package	Charge	What they get
Question call	**€29**	One hour. You answer their questions about courses, cities, money, and the order of steps.
University plan	**€79**	A written shortlist of 5 to 8 programmes, with deadlines, language, and the documents that programme asks for.
Application support	**€149**	The university plan, plus feedback on the CV and motivation letter, and help to prepare up to 3 applications.
Full student guide	**€249**	Everything above, plus a visa-document checklist taken from the embassy website, blocked-account explanation, and a simple arrival list.
Each extra application	**€40**	One more university, after the first three.
Fast turnaround	**+ €30**	They need your part in under 7 days. Add this on top of the package.

Use euro as the price. If someone pays from India, convert on the day they pay. As a rough picture only, €249 is on the order of ■25,000, not a fixed rupee price. Do not lock an old exchange rate into the offer.

Which price to offer first

Most people who message you only need a direction. Offer the free 15-minute talk, then the €79 university plan. Move them to €149 or €249 only when they ask you to work on documents or the visa checklist. Do not quote €249 in the first two messages. It feels heavy before they trust you.

When to charge less, and when not to

- A classmate or a close referral can get about 20 percent off one package. Say it is a one-time student discount.
- Do not drop the full guide below €180. Under that, the hours are no longer worth it and people treat the work as casual chat.
- If their case is unusual — a previous visa refusal, a large study gap, or marks far below the programme — charge the full guide, not the cheap call. Those cases take longer and you must be more careful.
- Do not work “for exposure” or for a promise to pay after the visa. Too many people disappear.

3. How to explain the real cost of Germany

Tell them your consultancy fee is the small part. The large part is living money and official fees. If you hide that, they will feel cheated later.

- **Tuition.** Many German public universities charge no tuition. They do charge a semester contribution, often roughly €100 to €400, and the amount is different at each university. Baden-Württemberg is an exception: non-EU students there usually pay tuition of about €1,500 per semester. Always open the university’s own fee page with them.
- **Blocked account.** For a student visa, a common way to prove living money is a blocked account (Sperrkonto). The figure widely used for 2026 is **€11,904 for 12 months, which is €992 a month**. Tell them to confirm the exact number on the website of the German mission that handles their city before they transfer anything. The number can change, and some visa types use a different amount.
- **Other official costs.** Health insurance, the visa fee, translations, and sometimes a language test or uni-assist fee. These are paid to those offices, not to you.
- **Your fee.** €29 to €249 depending on the package. Say it once, in writing, with a list of what is included.

4. Words you can send

First WhatsApp reply

"Hello, thank you for your message. I help students who want to study in Germany. I am a student here myself, so I guide you from real experience, with a low fee. I am not a lawyer and I cannot guarantee admission or a visa. If you want, we can do a free 15-minute call. Please send your highest qualification, your percentage or CGPA, your English or German level, the subject you want, and which intake (summer or winter)."

After the free talk, when you name the price

"From what you told me, the useful next step is a university plan. I will send you 5 to 8 programmes that fit your marks and language, with the deadline and the document list for each. That is €79. I start after the payment, and you get the written plan within a few days. If you later want me to check your CV and motivation letter and prepare applications, that is a bigger package, €149 or €249. We do not have to decide that today."

If they ask why they should pay a student

"A big office will charge more, and many of them have never studied in Germany. I have. I will not invent a result for you. I will sit with the real university rules and the embassy checklist and tell you what is missing. You still submit the application in your own name. That is how it should be."

If they ask you to guarantee the visa

"I will not say that. Anyone who guarantees a German visa is not being honest. I can make your file clear and complete. The embassy decides."

5. The story you walk them through

Use this order on the call. Do not jump to the visa when they do not yet have a course.

- **1. Profile.** Qualification, marks, gaps, language test, passport, and the subject they actually want. If the subject and the marks do not match, say so early.
- **2. Money.** Can they show living costs for a year, around the blocked-account level, plus the semester contribution and insurance? If the money is not real, stop. Do not help them dress up a false bank paper.
- **3. Course list.** Public universities first if they want low tuition. Check the language of the programme. English-taught master's programmes are competitive. A bachelor's degree in German usually needs German.
- **4. Applications.** Some universities use uni-assist. Some have their own portal. Deadlines are often 15 July for the winter semester and 15 January for the summer semester, but many programmes close earlier. The university page wins over any general date.
- **5. Admission letter.** Only after a real offer do you move to the visa file.
- **6. Visa file.** Open the checklist of the German mission for their country and go line by line. Typical items include the admission letter, passport, biometric photo, proof of funds, health insurance, and sometimes APS or a language certificate. If a line is not on their embassy list, do not invent it.
- **7. After arrival.** Register the address (Anmeldung), unblock or activate the monthly payout, get health insurance in place, enrol at the university, and pay the semester contribution.

APS applies to some countries and not others. India currently uses APS for many study routes. Do not guess. Look at the APS page for their country before you tell them to apply.

6. How you take the money

- Send a short WhatsApp message before any payment: package name, price, what is included, what is not included, and how many days you need.

- For the €29 call and the €79 plan, ask for the full amount before you start. The work is short.
- For €149 or €249, ask for **€80 first**. Ask for the rest when you deliver the written plan and start the document review. If they stop before you start, return the money. If you already did the work, that part stays paid.
- Accept a normal bank transfer or a payment app you both can see. Do not take cash from someone you have never met without a written note of what it was for.
- Keep one folder per person: their messages, the checklist, and the files they sent. Do not mix two students' documents.
- Their password for a university portal stays with them. You can sit on a call and tell them what to click. You should not keep their portal password.

7. A simple week, so you do not overwork

- Take at most 3 full-guide students at the same time while you are studying.
- Reply within one day, even if the reply is only "I will look at this tomorrow." Silence makes people think the fee was a trick.
- One free 15-minute talk per person. If they want a second long chat, that is the €29 call.
- Put your own lectures and exams first. Tell them your exam week in advance and pause new clients that week.

One line to remember

Your position

"I am a student in Germany. I know how to do this because I did it. I will guide you clearly, for a low fee. I will not sell you a promise the embassy has not made."

Prepared on 4 October 2026 for Zameer. Blocked-account and tuition figures are for explanation. Before a client transfers money, confirm the amount on the German mission website and the university fee page for that intake.